

What Would YOU do?

Interactive Scenarios Ancient Greece Through Their Eyes

This assignment involves engaging with interactive Ancient Greece scenarios. As you read about this remarkable civilization, imagine yourself in various historical situations, and answer the "What would you do?" questions. At the end, you will complete a creative writing piece reflecting on your experiences and thoughts.

Steps to Follow:

Read the Scenario: Carefully read the provided Ancient Greece scenarios. Try to envision yourself in the situations described, considering the historical context of Ancient Greece and the challenges faced by the characters.

Answer the Questions: For each scenario, answer the "What would you do?" questions. Think about why you would make these choices and how they reflect on the situation at hand in Ancient Greece.

Reflect on Your Decisions: After answering the questions, spend some time reflecting on your choices. Consider how these decisions might have impacted you and others if you were actually in those Ancient Greece situations.

Creative Writing Assignment: Write a reflective piece based on your responses. This can be a diary entry, a letter, a narrative, or even a poem. Explore the emotions, challenges, and potential outcomes of the decisions you made in the scenarios.

Goal of the Assignment:

- To gain insight into the personal experiences and tough choices faced in Ancient Greece.
- To develop empathy and understanding for historical events and their impact on individuals in the context of one of the world's oldest civilizations.
- To explore creative expression through reflective writing, delving into the rich cultural and historical tapestry of Ancient Greece.

Remember, your creative piece should be a personal reflection of your thoughts and feelings as you navigated the scenarios, so there are no right or wrong answers. Be honest, thoughtful, and creative in your responses. Good luck!

What Would YOU do?

Crossroads of Destiny: The Athenian's Choice

In the pivotal age of the 5th century BCE, you are a resident of Athens, the heart of cultural and intellectual activity in Ancient Greece. This period is marked by significant developments in art, philosophy, and the sciences, with figures like Socrates and Hippocrates contributing to a flourishing of Greek thought and knowledge. Athens, under the statesman Pericles, has become a shining example of democracy, where citizens engage in open debate and decision-making in the Agora, the central public space of the city.

However, this golden age of enlightenment is under threat. The mighty Persian Empire, a vast and powerful realm that spans from Asia Minor to the edges of India, has turned its attention to the relatively small and divided city-states of Greece. Already, many Greek city-states in Asia Minor have fallen under Persian rule, and now, the empire seeks to subdue the free cities of mainland Greece.

The memory of the Battle of Marathon ten years earlier, where the Athenian army achieved an unlikely victory against the Persians, is a source of pride but also a stark reminder of the empire's desire for revenge. Now, a much larger Persian force, led by King Xerxes, is preparing to invade. The impending conflict will determine the fate of Greek independence and the survival of its fledgling democratic ideals.



In Athens, debates rage about how to respond to this existential threat. Some advocate for a direct military confrontation, recalling the glory of Marathon, while others propose seeking alliances with other Greek city-states, including Sparta, known for its military prowess. Still, others consider the option of negotiation with Persia, to avoid the devastation of war.

1. As an Athenian in this critical moment of history, facing the colossal might of the Persian Empire, what path do you choose in the defense of your city and its cherished ideals? (circle one)

Join the Athenian Forces: Do you take up arms and join the ranks of the Athenian army, ready to defend your city's freedom and democratic way of life, standing shoulder to shoulder with your fellow citizens on the battlefield?

Contribute to the War Effort: Do you decide to support the war effort in Athens, using your skills and knowledge in other ways, such as crafting weapons, providing medical aid, or aiding in the city's strategic defense planning?

Seek Refuge: Do you choose to flee Athens, seeking safety for yourself and your family in a neutral or less threatened Greek city-state, preserving your life but leaving behind your home and the fate of your city in the balance?

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. What are some of the things you learned about Ancient Greece in this scenario? (2-3 sentences)

What Would YOU do?

Whispers of Delphi: A Prophecy's Weight

In the classical era of Ancient Greece, around the 5th century BCE, you find yourself living in a time steeped in mythology, philosophy, and the pursuit of knowledge. This is a period where city-states like Athens, Sparta, and Corinth dominate the landscape, each with its unique customs and governance. The Greek world is a tapestry of fierce rivalries, alliances, and a shared admiration for the divine.

Among the many traditions of your time is the practice of consulting the Oracle of Delphi, a priestess at the Temple of Apollo, believed to channel the god's will. People from across the Greek world, from kings to commoners, seek the Oracle's guidance on matters ranging from personal decisions to state affairs. The Oracle's cryptic prophecies have shaped wars, political power struggles, and personal destinies.

As a resident of one of the city-states, you've always been intrigued by the tales of the Oracle's enigmatic predictions. Driven by a desire for insight into your own life's path, you

- undertake the journey to the sacred site of Delphi. The temple, perched on the slopes of Mount Parnassus, overlooks a breathtaking
- vista of valleys and the shimmering sea beyond.



Upon your arrival, you are granted an audience with the Oracle. In a trance-like state, she utters a prophecy concerning your future: "The path you walk is shadowed by the eagle's flight, and where its shadow falls, destiny awaits." The words are cryptic, leaving you more puzzled than enlightened, hinting at a future fraught with ambiguity and possibly danger.

1. In the world of Ancient Greece, where the gods' will is sought and revered, what decision do you make in the face of a prophecy that could shape your destiny? (circle one)

Alter Your Path: Do you take the prophecy as a warning, choosing to alter your current life path in an attempt to avoid the unknown dangers the Oracle's words seem to imply?

Continue as Usual: Do you decide to dismiss the prophecy's ambiguity, choosing instead to continue living your life as usual, without allowing the Oracle's words to influence your choices?

Seek Further Guidance: Do you seek further guidance from the gods, perhaps through additional sacrifices or consulting another temple, to gain clearer insight into the meaning and implications of the Oracle's prophecy?

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. What factors did you consider the most when making this decision - explain. (2-3 sentences)

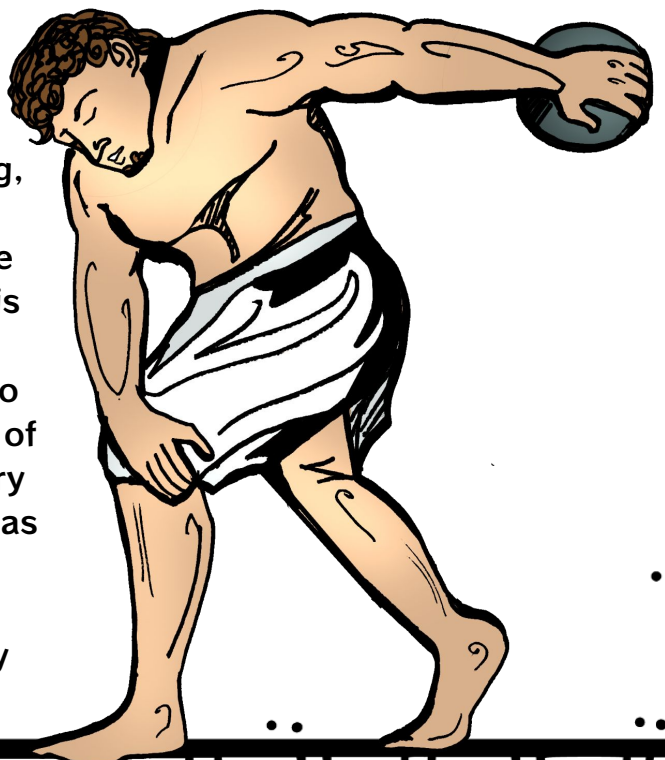
What Would YOU do?

The Olympian's Decision: Glory or Duty?

In the vibrant world of Ancient Greece, around 400 BCE, you are poised at a significant moment in your life. This period is an age of enlightenment and cultural brilliance, where the Greek city-states, or poleis, have achieved great advancements in philosophy, drama, art, and democracy, particularly in Athens under the leadership of figures like Pericles. Meanwhile, Sparta represents the pinnacle of military discipline and prowess. The Greek world is a complex tapestry of alliances, rivalries, and a shared cultural heritage, prominently celebrated through the Olympic Games.

Originating in 776 BCE, the Olympic Games are held every four years at Olympia, in honor of Zeus, the king of the gods. These games are more than just athletic contests; they are a religious festival and a gathering for the Greek-speaking world, transcending the usual animosities and conflicts of the various city-states. The victors of these games are celebrated as heroes and bring great honor to their hometowns, often receiving rewards like lifetime supplies of food, statues in their likeness, or even having poems written about their deeds.

As a talented young athlete in both pankration, a grueling sport that combines wrestling and boxing, and also in discus throwing, you have the potential to compete in these prestigious games. Your skill and dedication have caught the attention of local trainers, and there is a growing buzz about your prospects as an Olympic competitor. The community's elders, who recall the stories of past Olympians, often speak of your potential to join the ranks of these legendary figures. Furthermore, your prowess in athletics has even started to attract the notice of wealthy patrons, who are considering sponsoring your training in hopes of basking in the reflected glory of your potential victories.



Yet, your personal circumstances present a stark challenge. Your family, known for its pottery craftsmanship, relies heavily on your contribution, especially now with your father's failing health. In Ancient Greece, family trades are a crucial part of the local economy and social structure, often passed down through generations. Leaving to train for the Olympics means leaving your family to shoulder the burden alone during a critical time.

1. In an era where both athletic glory and familial responsibility are deeply valued, what path do you choose as a young Greek with the potential for greatness? (circle one)

Commit to Olympic Training: Do you seize the opportunity to train for the Olympics, aspiring to bring glory to your name and polis, fully immersing yourself in the pursuit of athletic excellence and potentially securing a place in history?

Devote Yourself to Family Duty: Do you choose to stay and dedicate yourself to your family's pottery trade, ensuring their wellbeing and the continuation of your family's legacy, but at the cost of forgoing your Olympic dreams?

Seek a Balanced Approach: Attempt to balance training for the Olympics with working in your family's trade. This could mean training in your free time or seeking help and apprentices to maintain the business in your absence, striving to honor both your personal aspirations and family obligations.

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. What steps did you take to arrive at your decision? Did you rely more on intuition, logic, emotion, or a combination of these? (2-3 sentences)

What Would YOU do?

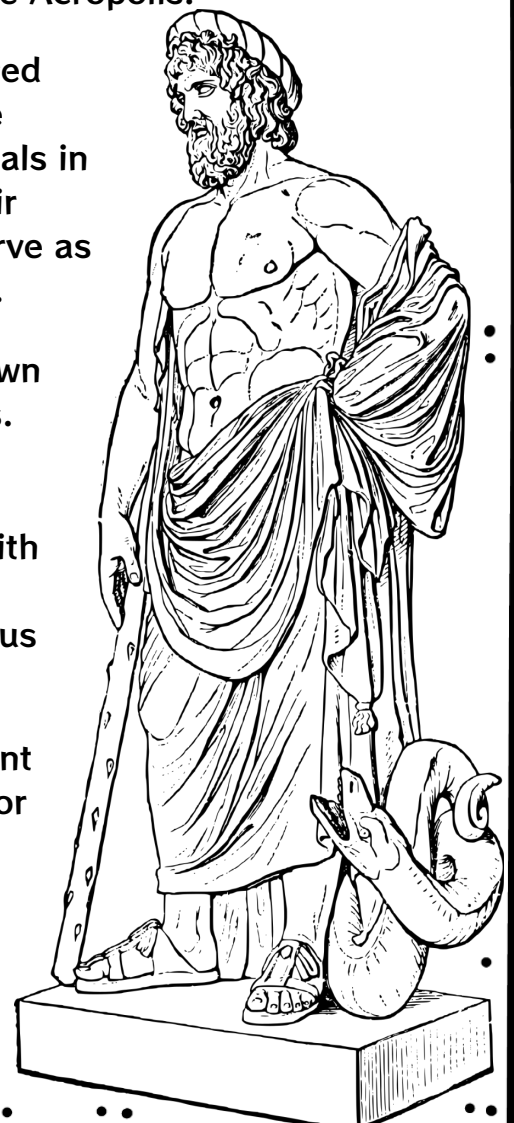
The Sculptor's Conscience: A Test of Art and Faith

In the classical period of Ancient Greece, particularly in the 5th century BCE, you live in an era of unparalleled cultural and artistic achievement. Athens, under the statesman Pericles, is at the zenith of its power, known as the Golden Age. It is a time of great philosophers like Socrates, dramatists like Sophocles, and historians like Herodotus. The city is a bustling hub of intellectual discourse and artistic innovation, famed for its majestic structures like the Parthenon and the Acropolis.

Amidst this backdrop of enlightenment, art is a revered pursuit, intrinsically linked with religious and civic life. The Greeks believe in embodying the divine and the human ideals in stone and bronze, with sculptors held in high esteem. Their works are not only displays of artistic prowess but also serve as offerings to the gods and as representations of civic pride.

You, a sculptor in this vibrant city, have gained renown for your skillful renditions of the human form and the gods. Sculpture in this age is a means of expressing the philosophical ideals of harmony, balance, and beauty. However, the artistic world of Athens is also intertwined with its religious beliefs, with patronage often coming from religious institutions and wealthy citizens devoted to various deities.

Your latest potential commission presents a significant moral challenge. You have been asked to create a statue for a temple dedicated to a deity whose attributes and associated myths conflict with your personal philosophical leanings.



In a society where philosophy often intersects with theology, this puts you at odds with the prevailing beliefs and practices. The deity in question might be associated with aspects like hedonism, revenge, or other traits you find objectionable or contrary to your philosophical school of thought.

1. In an age where art, philosophy, and religion are deeply intertwined, what decision do you make as a sculptor in ancient Athens, balancing your personal ethics with your professional artistry? (circle one)

Accept the Commission: Do you accept this high-profile commission, setting aside your personal beliefs in favor of artistic expression and the acclaim it would bring?

Decline on Moral Grounds: Do you decline the commission based on your philosophical convictions, potentially risking future patronage and your standing in the artistic community?

Propose an Alternative: Could you negotiate an alternative that aligns more closely with your beliefs, such as suggesting a sculpture of a deity or concept that better reflects your philosophical ideals?

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. How might your spiritual beliefs be involved in your decision? (2-3 sentences)



What Would YOU do?

Athens Awaits: The Call to Serve

In the 5th century BCE, you are a resident of Athens, the heart of democracy and philosophy in Ancient Greece. This period is marked by significant developments, not just in the arts and sciences, but in the very way a society can govern itself. Athens, under the guidance of leaders like Pericles, is experimenting with a form of government that is radically new: democracy. Every citizen has the right to speak and vote in the Assembly, where decisions affecting the entire city are made.

Athens is a city bustling with intellectual debates, where the concepts of justice, ethics, and civic duty are not abstract ideas but part of everyday life. The Agora, the central public space in Athens, is where citizens gather to discuss the affairs of the state, engage in commerce, and socialize. Here, influential figures like Socrates challenge the minds of the young, and decisions made by the Assembly can change the course of history.

As a citizen of Athens, you have always been an active participant in the Assembly, voicing your opinions and casting your votes on various matters. Your eloquence and clear reasoning have not gone unnoticed, and now you are presented with a significant opportunity to enter the political arena as a strategos, one of the leading political and military positions in Athens.



However, this decision is not without its dilemmas. Athenian politics can be a treacherous landscape, filled with rivalries and opportunities for corruption. While some leaders seek the greater good, others are swayed by personal gain. Entering politics means navigating this complex world, where your decisions could impact not just your life but the future of Athens itself.

1. As a citizen of ancient Athens, standing at the forefront of democratic thought and practice, what choice do you make in shaping your role in this historic city? (circope one)

Pursue a Political Career: Do you seize this opportunity to become a leader in Athens, using your position to influence positive change and guide the city through these turbulent times?

Stay Out of Politics: Do you choose to remain a private citizen, staying clear of the potential corruption and power struggles of political life, but also giving up the chance to effect change from within?

Personal Gain: Or do you enter politics with the aim of using your position for personal enrichment, aligning with those who seek power and wealth, albeit at the potential cost of Athens' democratic ideals?

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. What do you think could go wrong with this new system of democracy (people having a say/vote in elections)? (2-3 sentences)

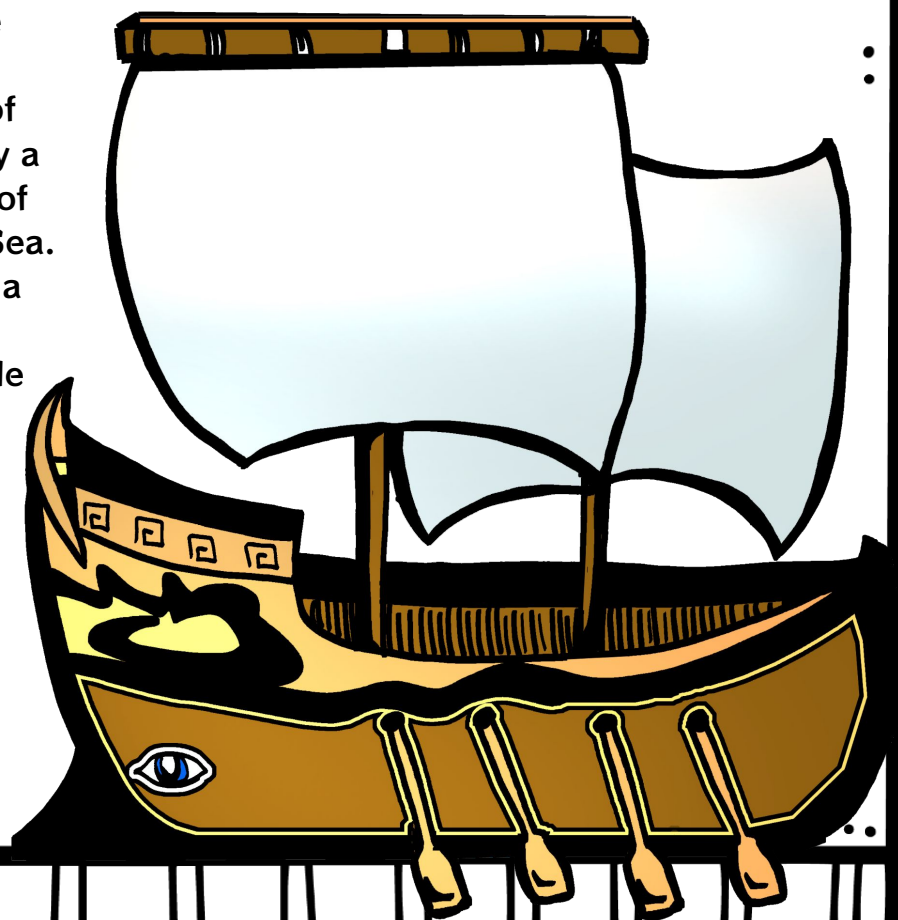
What Would YOU do?

Odyssey of the Aegean: A Quest for the Golden Fleece

It's the era of myth and legend in Ancient Greece, a time when the world is filled with gods and heroes, and epic tales like Homer's "Odyssey" and "Iliad" are not just stories but part of the fabric of life. It's the 8th century BCE, a time when the Greek city-states are rising in power, and the seas of the Aegean are a vast expanse of mystery and adventure. Maritime expeditions are both perilous and promising, leading to new lands, riches, and legendary exploits.

You are a young adventurer from the bustling city-state of Corinth, a place known for its skilled artisans, flourishing trade, and strategic location controlling the land route between the Peloponnese and mainland Greece. Inspired by the tales of heroes like Achilles, Odysseus, and Heracles, you dream of embarking on a journey that will etch your name in the annals of history.

Your opportunity for adventure arrives when you hear rumors of the Golden Fleece, a legendary artifact of immense value said to be guarded by a fearsome dragon in the distant land of Colchis, on the shores of the Black Sea. The fleece is not just a treasure; it's a symbol of kingship and divine favor. Capturing it would bring unimaginable honor to you and your city.



As you prepare your ship and gather a crew of brave souls, each skilled in various arts of war and navigation, you feel the weight of the journey ahead. The seas are treacherous, filled with monsters, pirates, and tempests, and Colchis is a land of unknown dangers.

1. As a daring adventurer in the age of Greek legends, what decision do you make at the onset of your epic quest for the Golden Fleece? (circle one)

Seek the Blessing of the Gods: Do you first sail to Delphi to seek the guidance of the Oracle and the blessings of the gods for your journey, understanding that divine favor is often the difference between success and ruin in such epic quests?

Direct Route to Colchis: Do you choose the most direct route to Colchis, braving the uncertain seas in the pursuit of glory and risking the unknown dangers that might lie directly in your path?

Gather Allies: Do you sail to other Greek city-states first, seeking to gather allies and additional resources, potentially strengthening your expedition but losing precious time?

2. Why did you choose this option over the other choices? (1-2 sentences)

3. What could go wrong with your decision? (1-2 sentences)

4. In making this decision, which risks would concern you the most, and how would you try to minimize them? (2-4 sentences)

Creative Writing

Choose one of the prompts below and write a creative response, exploring the emotions, challenges, and experiences faced by citizens in the time of Ancient Greece.

Olympic Training Journal: Write a series of diary entries from the perspective of an athlete training for the Olympics, detailing the daily challenges, personal sacrifices, and the pressure to bring honor to your city-state.

Letter Home from War: As a soldier deciding whether to go to war, compose a heartfelt letter to your family explaining your decision, your fears, and your hopes.

The Sculptor's Reflection: Write a monologue for a sculptor who is conflicted about accepting a commission that goes against their beliefs, exploring the internal struggle between artistic integrity and societal expectations.

Political Career Speech: Draft a speech announcing your decision to either enter or avoid the political arena in Athens, highlighting your reasoning and vision for the future of the city-state.

Oracle's Prophecy Story: Create a narrative where you, after receiving a vague prophecy from the Oracle of Delphi, embark on a journey that leads to unexpected adventures and self-discovery.

Golden Fleece Adventure: Write a short adventure story about your journey to seek the Golden Fleece, including encounters with mythical creatures, challenges at sea, and the ultimate outcome of your quest.

A Day in the Agora: Describe a day in the life of an Athenian citizen visiting the Agora, encountering philosophers, politicians, and traders, and the conversations and debates you engage in.

Philosopher's Dialogue: Create a dialogue between two philosophers discussing a major issue of the day (e.g., democracy vs. oligarchy, the nature of the gods), showcasing their arguments and the philosophical depth of Ancient Greek thought.

Spartan Warrior's Tale: As a Spartan warrior, write a first-person account of your rigorous training, your life's philosophy, and your preparation for an upcoming battle, reflecting on the Spartan ideals of duty, strength, and discipline.

Creative Writing Rubric

Content and Accuracy (25 points)

- **Exemplary (20-25 points):** The writing is historically accurate, showing a deep understanding of the Ancient Greece scenario. It includes specific details and factual information relevant to the chosen prompt.
- **Proficient (15-19 points):** The writing demonstrates a good understanding of the Ancient Greece scenario, with some relevant details and factual accuracy.
- **Basic (10-14 points):** The writing shows a basic understanding of the Ancient Greece scenario but lacks depth and detail.
- **Below Basic (0-9 points):** The writing demonstrates limited or inaccurate understanding of the Ancient Greece scenario.

Creativity and Originality (25 points)

- **Exemplary (20-25 points):** The writing is highly creative and original, offering a unique perspective or interpretation of the prompt.
- **Proficient (15-19 points):** The writing is somewhat creative and shows some original thoughts.
- **Basic (10-14 points):** The writing is fairly standard, with minimal originality or creativity.
- **Below Basic (0-9 points):** The writing lacks originality and fails to creatively engage with the prompt.

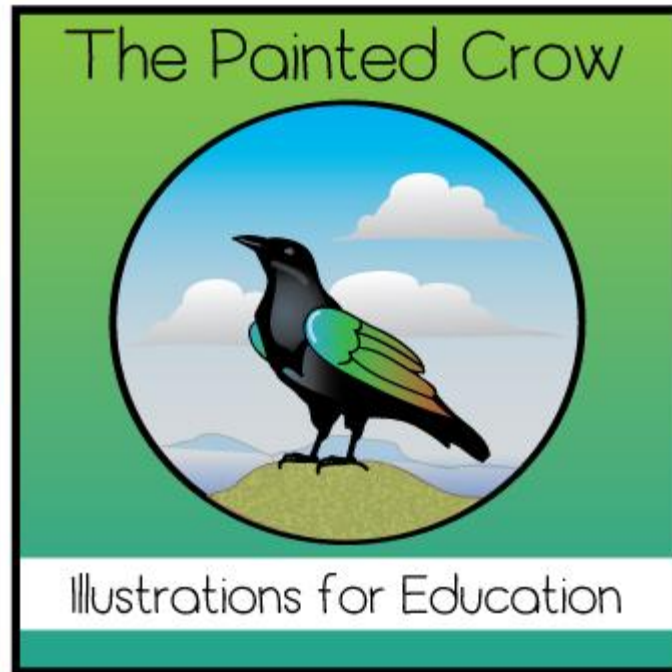
Expression and Clarity (25 points)

- **Exemplary (20-25 points):** The writing is clear and expressive, with well-structured sentences and paragraphs that flow logically.
- **Proficient (15-19 points):** The writing is mostly clear and structured, with occasional lapses in clarity or expression.
- **Basic (10-14 points):** The writing is somewhat clear but may have some structural weaknesses or lack of flow.
- **Below Basic (0-9 points):** The writing is unclear, disorganized, and difficult to follow.

Grammar and Mechanics (25 points)

- **Exemplary (20-25 points):** The writing is free of grammatical and mechanical errors, demonstrating excellent command of language.
- **Proficient (15-19 points):** The writing contains few grammatical or mechanical errors.
- **Basic (10-14 points):** The writing has some grammatical and mechanical errors that may distract the reader.
- **Below Basic (0-9 points):** The writing has numerous grammatical and mechanical errors, significantly hindering readability.

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